promulgation' of his message there.[52] Whatever the ancient name of the present site of Panguraria, it was by then already a Buddhist sanctuary. This means that the intended audience, unlike many other audiences, for the emperor's inscription was a monastic community already in existence at this location. Ashoka's edict here is similar to those at Maski and Rupnath, but the fact that the intended audience here was Buddhist will have resulted in a different kind of reception for it.

The resident monks and nuns will, one assumes, have felt greatly reassured about the rightness of the path they had chosen, considering their afflictions worth the while now that this same path was being trodden by the emperor himself. The mendicants here, as in the other viharas that Ashoka will have visited, may nonetheless have been surprised by the import of his message. Kings as conquerors of the lands of other rulers, or as builders of political capitals, were commonly encountered within stories that circulated in the third century BCE of the time of the Sakyamuni. Here, however, was a king proclaiming he was one of them. What next? Might he decide to join them and live among them? The tenor of these new proclamations might well have made the discerning feel there was no saying what might happen in the future.